

GlowMart

Complete Skincare Guide by Skin Type

Understanding Your Skin Type

Knowing your skin type is the foundation of an effective skincare routine. The five main skin types are: oily (shiny T-zone, enlarged pores, prone to breakouts), dry (tight feeling after cleansing, flaky patches, rough texture, may appear dull), combination (oily in the T-zone but dry or normal on cheeks), normal (balanced moisture, few imperfections, small pores), and sensitive (easily irritated, prone to redness, stinging, or burning with certain products). You can determine your skin type with a simple blotting test: cleanse your face, wait one hour without applying any products, then press blotting paper to different areas. Oily skin will saturate the paper; dry skin will leave it clean; combination skin will show oil only from the T-zone. Skin type can change with age, seasons, hormones, and medication, so reassess every 6-12 months.

The Correct Order of Application

Skincare products should be applied from thinnest to thickest consistency. The correct morning order is: cleanser, toner, essence, serum, eye cream, moisturizer, sunscreen. The correct evening order is: makeup remover or cleansing oil (if wearing makeup), cleanser, exfoliant (2-3 times per week only), toner, essence, treatment serum, eye cream, night cream or sleeping mask. Always wait 30-60 seconds between layers to allow each product to absorb. Never mix certain actives in the same routine: vitamin C and retinol should be used at different times of day, and AHAs/BHAs should not be combined with retinol in the same application.

Routine for Oily Skin

Morning: Start with a foaming gel cleanser to remove overnight sebum without stripping the moisture barrier. Follow with an exfoliating toner containing 2 percent salicylic acid (BHA) to penetrate and unclog pores. Apply a niacinamide serum (5-10 percent) to regulate oil production, minimize pore appearance, and reduce redness. Use a lightweight gel moisturizer that provides hydration through hyaluronic acid without adding oil. Finish with a mineral sunscreen SPF 50 in a matte finish formula. Evening: Double cleanse starting with micellar water or oil cleanser, followed by your foaming gel cleanser. Apply a retinol serum (start with 0.25 percent and work up to 1 percent) 2-3 times per week. On non-retinol nights, use a clay purifying mask or a BHA treatment. Follow with a lightweight night gel.

Routine for Dry Skin

Morning: Use a cream or oil cleanser that gently removes impurities while preserving the moisture barrier. Apply a hydrating essence with fermented ingredients to boost absorption. Follow with a hyaluronic acid serum (multi-weight formula with both low and high molecular weight HA for deep and surface hydration). Layer a rich butter cream or ceramide-based moisturizer. Finish with a hydrating sunscreen SPF 50 that doubles as a moisturizer. Evening: Remove makeup with a cleansing balm that melts into an oil. Follow with your cream cleanser. Apply a retinol serum in a hydrating base 2-3 times per week. On alternate nights, use a peptide complex serum to strengthen the skin barrier and support collagen production. Seal everything with a rich night repair cream. Two to three times per week, apply an overnight sleeping mask as the final step for

intense overnight hydration.

Routine for Combination Skin

The key to combination skin is using different products on different zones when needed. Morning: Cleanse with a gentle micellar water or cream-to-foam cleanser. Apply a balancing toner with witch hazel and glycerin to normalize oil across all zones. Use a vitamin C serum (15-20 percent L-ascorbic acid) for antioxidant protection and brightening. Choose a lightweight lotion that hydrates without clogging pores. Finish with a hybrid sunscreen SPF 50. Evening: Double cleanse with an oil cleanser followed by your cream-to-foam cleanser. Apply a niacinamide serum to balance oil production. Use a lightweight night lotion on the full face, adding a richer eye cream and lip treatment to the driest areas. Once a week, use a multi-masking approach: clay mask on the T-zone and a hydrating sheet mask on the cheeks.

Routine for Sensitive Skin

Choose fragrance-free, hypoallergenic, and dermatologist-tested products exclusively. Morning: Use a gentle cream cleanser without sulfates (SLS/SLES-free), parabens, or synthetic fragrance. Apply a rose water or chamomile mist as a soothing toner to calm any morning redness. Use a centella asiatica (cica) serum or peptide complex to strengthen the skin barrier and reduce inflammation. Moisturize with a daily hydrating cream formulated for sensitive skin, containing ceramides and panthenol. Finish with a mineral-only sunscreen (zinc oxide or titanium dioxide) SPF 50, as chemical filters can irritate sensitive skin. Evening: Cleanse gently with the same cream cleanser. Apply a bakuchiol serum as a gentle retinol alternative. Follow with a calming night cream with oat extract and allantoin. Always patch-test new products on your inner forearm for 48 hours before applying to your face. Introduce only one new product at a time, waiting two weeks before adding another.

Anti-Aging Additions for Any Skin Type

For customers concerned about aging, the three most evidence-backed ingredients are retinol, vitamin C, and sunscreen. Retinol (vitamin A derivative) promotes cell turnover, reduces fine lines, and evens skin tone. Start with 0.25 percent retinol 2 nights per week and gradually increase to 1 percent nightly over 3-6 months. Common side effects include purging (temporary breakouts as clogged pores clear), dryness, and peeling during the first 2-4 weeks. Always use sunscreen when using retinol. Vitamin C (L-ascorbic acid at 15-20 percent) is a morning antioxidant that brightens, protects against UV-induced free radical damage, and supports collagen synthesis. Store vitamin C serums in a cool, dark place as they oxidize quickly. Peptides are amino acid chains that signal the skin to produce more collagen. Apply a peptide eye cream morning and evening to the orbital bone area using your ring finger.

Sunscreen Is Non-Negotiable

Regardless of skin type, age, or weather, apply sunscreen every morning as the last step of your skincare routine and before makeup. UV damage is the number one cause of premature aging, hyperpigmentation, and skin cancer. UVA rays (aging rays) penetrate clouds and windows, so sunscreen is necessary even on overcast days and while driving. Reapply every 2 hours when outdoors, or immediately after swimming, sweating, or toweling off. Use a nickel-sized amount (about one quarter teaspoon) for the face alone. GlowMart offers mineral sunscreens (zinc oxide or titanium dioxide that sit on top of skin, good for sensitive skin), chemical sunscreens (absorb UV rays, lighter texture, good for oily skin), and hybrid formulas

(combination of both) in various formulations including tinted, sport, stick, and lightweight fluid.

Common Skincare Mistakes

1. Over-cleansing: Washing more than twice daily strips natural oils and damages the moisture barrier. 2. Skipping moisturizer for oily skin: Even oily skin needs hydration; use a gel or water-based moisturizer. 3. Using too many actives at once: Combining AHA, BHA, retinol, and vitamin C in one routine causes irritation. 4. Not giving products enough time: Most actives take 6-12 weeks of consistent use to show visible results. 5. Applying eye cream incorrectly: Use your ring finger and tap product along the orbital bone. 6. Neglecting the neck: Extend your entire routine including sunscreen to your neck and chest. 7. Sleeping in makeup: Even one night can clog pores and accelerate aging. 8. Using expired products: Check the PAO symbol and replace products that have changed.

Seasonal Skincare Adjustments

Spring: Transition from heavy winter creams to lighter lotions. Increase exfoliation frequency to remove winter buildup. Start using vitamin C daily as UV exposure increases. Summer: Switch to gel moisturizers and lightweight sunscreen. Keep a facial mist in the refrigerator for cooling relief. Reduce retinol frequency if spending significant time outdoors. Autumn: Begin reintroducing richer serums and creams as humidity drops. Increase retinol frequency to address summer sun damage. Add a weekly hydrating mask. Winter: Use the richest versions of your cleanser and moisturizer. Add a facial oil as the last step before bed. Use a humidifier at night to counteract dry indoor heating. Reduce exfoliation as the skin barrier is more vulnerable in cold, dry conditions.